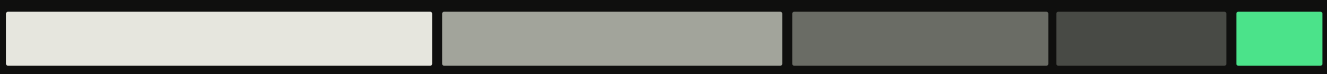
koverr

FREE GUIDE · 6 PAGES · 10 MINUTES

Got a breach email? Here's the fix.

What each leaked detail means, what someone can do with it, and the exact step that makes it useless to them. In the order that matters.



Works in	Checked	Your first win
UK, EU, US	12 November 2026	5 minutes, page 2

STEP 1 · READ IT PROPERLY

Get four answers out of the email in a minute.

Breach notices are written by lawyers to be accurate, not useful. Pull these four facts out and the rest of this guide tells you what to do with them.

1 · Who was breached?

The company that lost the data. Not always the one you think: it may be a supplier, a loyalty scheme or a service you signed up to years ago.

2 · What was taken?

Look for a list such as “names, email addresses, dates of birth”. These are the rows you look up on pages 3 and 4. If the email does not say, assume email address and password.

3 · Was your password in it?

“Hashed” or “encrypted” passwords are harder to use, not impossible. Treat any password in a breach as known.

4 · Is the email real?

Scammers send fake breach notices. Do not click the links. Open the company’s website or app yourself and look for the notice there.

YOUR FIRST WIN · 5 MINUTES

See every breach your email has been in, and get told about the next one.

- [ ] **Search your email at haveibeenpwned.com** — 2 min
  Free and independent. It shows which breaches included your address and what was in each.
- [ ] **Turn on “Notify me” on the same site** — 2 min
  You get an email when your address turns up in a newly loaded breach. Confirm it from the email it sends you.
- [ ] **Write the breach names in the box on page 5** — 1 min
  You will work through them in order, most dangerous first.

A clean result does not mean nothing leaked. No index sees every breach. It means none was found in the breaches that index holds.

STEP 2 · DECODE IT

What leaked, what it means, what fixes it.

Find each detail from the email. The shade shows how much harm it can do; the green column is the step that makes it useless.

WHAT LEAKED	WHAT SOMEONE CAN DO WITH IT	THE FIX
Password CRITICAL	Log in as you there, and on every other site where you used the same password. Criminals test leaked passwords against banks, email and shops automatically.	Change it on that site. Then change it everywhere you reused it, starting with your email account. Turn on two-step sign-in or a passkey. Sign out of other sessions. **10 min**
Bank or card details CRITICAL	Make purchases, or call you pretending to be your bank, quoting real digits to sound genuine.	Ask your bank to replace the card, using the number on the back of it. Check recent transactions. Turn on payment alerts in your banking app. **10 min**
ID numbers passport, driving licence, National Insurance, Social Security CRITICAL	Open accounts or apply for credit in your name. Pass identity checks.	**US:** freeze your credit at Equifax, Experian and TransUnion. It is free and you can lift it when you need credit. **UK:** check your credit file with the three agencies (free) and look for searches you don't recognise. If the passport or licence itself was lost, report it. **20 min**
Date of birth HIGH	Answer security questions, and make a scam call far more convincing. Combined with your address it is most of an identity.	You can't change it, so make it less useful: add two-step sign-in to email and banking, and treat any caller who "confirms" your birthday as unverified. **5 min**
Security questions and answers HIGH	Reset your password on any site that uses the same questions.	Change the answers there and anywhere else you used them. Better: use a made-up answer stored in a password manager. **5 min**
Home address HIGH	Post you convincing letters, add detail to scams, and add you to people-search listings.	Nothing to rotate. Lower its reach instead: see where it is already public (our free home-address guide covers this) and watch for post you didn't ask for. —

WHAT LEAKED	WHAT SOMEONE CAN DO WITH IT	THE FIX
Phone number MEDIUM	Scam calls and texts that name the breached company. In the worst case, a “SIM swap”: persuading your network to move your number to their SIM, then receiving your security codes.	Ask your mobile network to add a PIN or password to your account for any number transfer or SIM change. Move two-step sign-in for email and banking from text messages to an app or passkey. **10 min**
Email address only MEDIUM	Phishing that mentions the breached company by name, so it looks legitimate.	Expect emails “from” that company for a few months. Go to its site yourself rather than clicking links. Consider a separate address, or an alias, for new sign-ups. **1 min**
Name, username, gender, job title LOW	Little on its own. Useful to tailor a scam once combined with the rest.	No action on its own. Fix the higher rows first. —
Health, sexuality, religion, children’s data CRITICAL	Embarrassment, discrimination or extortion. Rare, but the most personal harm.	Be very wary of anyone who contacts you referring to it. Don’t pay or reply; report it to the police. In the UK or EU, you can complain to the data protection regulator about how the company protected it. —
Logins taken from your own device “stealer log”, “infostealer”, “malware” CRITICAL · DO FIRST	This is different: the leak was your computer or phone, not a company. Everything saved in that browser may be known, including sessions that skip two-step sign-in.	1. Scan and clean the device, or reset it. 2. From a *different, clean* device, change your email password first, then banking, then your password manager, then the rest. 3. Sign out of all sessions everywhere. 4. In your email settings, delete any forwarding rules or recovery addresses you didn’t add. **45–60 min**

WHY THE ORDER MATTERS

Your **email account** is the master key: almost every other password can be reset through it. If you only have ten minutes, secure your email first, then your bank, then the breached site.

STEP 3 · DO IT

Your next 30 minutes, most dangerous first.

A small study of real breach victims found only about a third changed the leaked password at all, and many chose one just as weak. Ticking these off already puts you ahead.

- [ ] **Secure your email account** — 8 min
  New, unique password. Two-step sign-in with an app or passkey. Check forwarding rules and recovery details.
- [ ] **Fix every critical row from pages 3–4** — 10–20 min
  Password reuse, card details, ID numbers, device logins. One at a time; tick each.
- [ ] **Add a PIN to your mobile account** — 5 min
  Stops someone moving your number to their SIM.
- [ ] **Ask one question about the breached company** — 5 min
  Do I still use it? If not, delete the account (look for “delete account” in settings), or ask the company to erase your data. Data that no longer exists can’t leak in the next breach.

My breaches

COMPANY	WHAT LEAKED	FIXED ON	ACCOUNT DELETED?

Skip the paid “dark web scan”. Seeing your email in a breach is free (page 2). What matters is the fix, which no scan does for you.
Source for the statistic above: Bhagavatula, Bauer & Kapadia, “(How) Do people change their passwords after a breach?”, 2020, a study of 63 people with accounts on breached sites.

WHAT COMES NEXT

A breach email is one leak. There are six ways out.

Your details also get sold by data brokers, shared by apps, printed on public registers, posted on old profiles and surfaced by search engines and AI. Koverr is being built to work all six: find where your data got out, fix what can be fixed, and keep a dated record of every fix.

Join the launch list ·koverr.com

Every alert comes with its fix

Like this guide, but for your own breaches, in your order.

You approve every request

Koverr drafts the deletion and opt-out requests; nothing is sent without your yes.

Proof, not promises

A dated record of what was found, what was asked and what was checked.

It doesn't stop at one

Listings come back and new breaches happen. Koverr rechecks.

Links and steps checked on 12 November 2026; services change their settings, so recheck from February 2027. This guide is general information, not legal or financial advice. Koverr is pre-launch: no scan or removal is performed by this guide. Have I Been Pwned is an independent service and is not affiliated with Koverr.